

Internal Policy Changes: LinkedIn Data Export Incident

Following the recent unauthorized export of LinkedIn user connection data, the following internal policy changes are recommended to strengthen data protection, enforce compliance, and prevent future privacy incidents:

1. Implement a dual-approval workflow for all user data exports, requiring authorization from both a direct supervisor and the Data Protection Officer (DPO).
2. Restrict data export functionality to employees with active, up-to-date data privacy and ethics certifications.
3. Establish real-time monitoring of export activities with automated alerts triggered by unusual or high-volume activity.
4. Introduce export thresholds and rate limits to prevent mass data transfers without proper justification.
5. Incorporate a 'data export history' section within internal dashboards for full visibility and accountability.
6. Enforce role-based access control (RBAC) to limit data export access based on job function and necessity.
7. Schedule quarterly audits of export permissions, access logs, and data handling practices.
8. Launch a company-wide Privacy Awareness Program, including mandatory refresher training for all employees.
9. Designate privacy champions in each department to act as peer educators and ethical accountability leads.
10. Include breach response simulations and tabletop exercises as part of regular privacy risk assessments.